주류동향

SINCE 1978

2026.10.20

SPECIAL REPORT / READING DECEMBER EARLY

Hof pubs shrink, year-end prep is on

Clues from two past winters of posts and this year's public booking notices



Weekly blog posts on year-end gatherings

01 **19,057**
Hof pubs nationwide · down 11.0% YoY

02 **Mid-December**
Year-end posts peaked there both winters

03 **Booking notices in October**
Max party size, parking, rooms first

How to read it

19,057
Hof pubs nationwide

Mid-Dec
Past posts peak

Wine #3
Drink mentions

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Hof pubs are shrinking, yet some venues already post year-end booking notices. We read past posts and public notices for year-end prep clues.

MARKET SNAPSHOT

Fewer pubs, earlier prep

August 2026 · Hof pubs nationwide

19,057

Below 20,000 for the first time (August basis)

Hof pubs are fewer, but year-end prep has begun. In two past winters, party posts peaked in mid-December; this year some venues opened bookings in October.

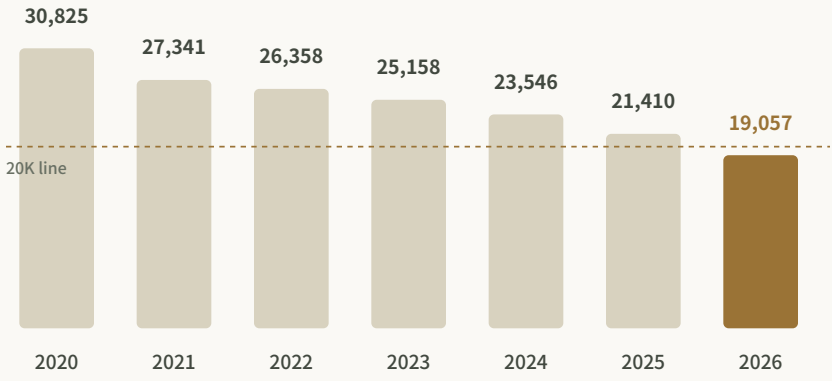
Posts do not show actual bookings or sales. They do show what info to share with guests early.

Hof pubs below 20K

An Oct 14 report citing National Tax Service data puts hof pubs at **19,057** in August: down 11.0% YoY and 38.2% vs. 2020.

Hof (Korean beer pub) businesses nationwide

August each year · count



-2,353

vs. same month last year

-11,768

vs. same month in 2020

Per NH NongHyup Bank's trend report (Jan 2026), spending at bars by people in their 20s fell **20.9%** last year.

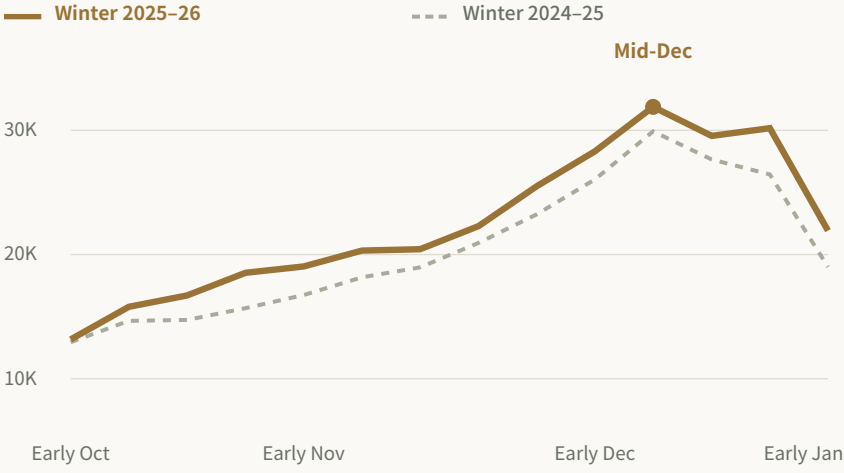
Counts of hof pub businesses each August. Not all bars; scope differs from other agencies' 'hof/casual bar' data.

Source: National Tax Service stats (each August), cited by Electronic Times (etnews) 2026.10.14. 2025 figure (21,410) as reported; declines recalculated. 20s bar spending: NH NongHyup Bank trend report, Jan 2026.

Party posts peak mid-Dec

Guide Weekly Naver Blog posts with at least one of: year-end dinner, year-end party, group dinner, dinner venue. Not split by author type.

Weekly posts



≈2.0–2.3×

Peak week vs. 2nd week of Oct
Dates differ by year

In both winters, posts rose from October to mid-December, then fell in early January. Use this to plan booking notices and venue info.

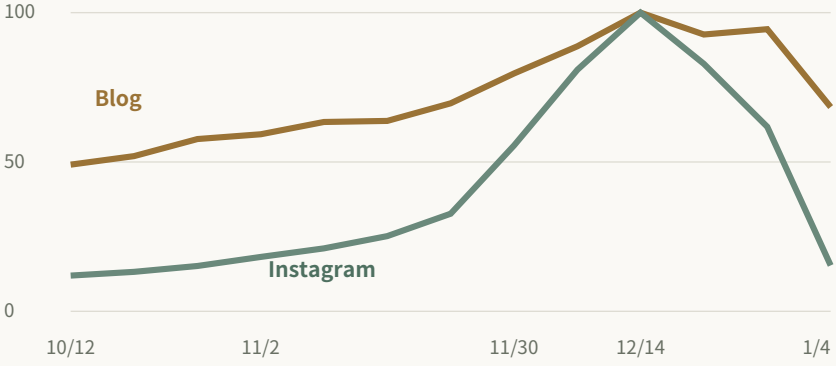
More posts do not mean more bookings or visits.

Source: Sometrend, Naver Blog, weekly 2024.10.6–2025.1.5 · 2025.10.5–2026.1.4. Seasons aligned by week order (dates differ by year). Ratio vs. 2nd week of Oct; 1st week of Oct 2025 excluded (Chuseok).

Blog vs. Insta timing differs

Guide Blog and Instagram posts for the same keywords, counted separately; each channel's peak = 100. Not classified by author or actual visitor.

2025.10.12~2026.1.4 Peak per channel = 100



Blog posts were at half their peak by mid-October; Instagram rose sharply from late November. **The channel lag is clear, but it does not mark when bookings are confirmed or visits occur.**

Booking notices in public posts

Hwangnam (Gwanghwamun) opened year-end bookings Oct 1, Joyanggwan (Gangnam) Oct 2, with capacity, parking, rooms.

Prepare booking hours, capacity and terms in advance.

Source: Sometrend, weekly 2025.10.12–2026.1.4. This year's absolute volumes excluded due to lower 2026 Instagram collection. Notices: public Instagram posts, collected 2026.10.17. Not by author type.

Family and lunch, too

Guide Words co-occurring in last Nov–Dec year-end party blog posts. Words overlap within posts; not guests' reasons or demand share.

Family

64K

Company dinner 61K



Similar level

Lunch

27K

Dinner 29K



Similar level

Venue info that co-occurred

Parking	Booking	Rooms	Sets	Courses
39K	26K	18K	16K	12K

Family-related words and lunch appeared often in these posts, as did parking, booking and rooms. **But mention order is not guests' actual priority in choosing a venue.**

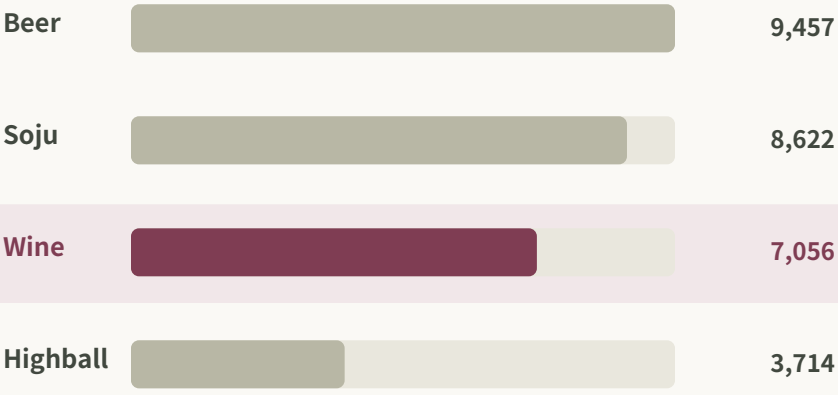
> **Tip for owners**
>
> Make max party size, parking and room availability easy to find in group booking notices. If you can host lunch groups, list hours and menu terms too.

Source: Sometrend related words, Naver Blog 2025.11.1–12.31. Keywords: year-end dinner|year-end party|group dinner|dinner venue; top 120. Words may overlap. Family-gathering terms not added to 'family'.

Wine ranks third

Guide Counts of drink names in year-end gathering blog posts. Drinks overlap within posts, so these are not sales or shares of all posts.

Nov–Dec 2025 · drink name mentions



1.9 ×

Wine 7,056 / Highball 3,714
Mention frequency, not sales share

Tip for owners

If adding wine, first check bottle vs. glass sales, storage and turnover. In group sets, state drinks and bottle counts clearly.

One post can name several drinks, so totals differ from the post count.

Source: Sometrend, Naver Blog, 2025.11.1–12.31. Counts of 4 drink names in top related words (beer, soju, wine, highball). One post can name several; not actual sales ranking.

Notices repeat three things

Some venues' public posts barely mention drinks, leading with booking dates and terms. Here is what recurred.

01 Year-end booking notices from October

Hwangnam (10/1) and Joyanggwan Gangnam (10/2) posted early. Booking start and available dates vary by venue.

02 Spell out capacity, parking, rooms

Joyanggwan listed rooms, max capacity and access; Hwangnam, max capacity and parking hours. Both let guests find key info at a glance before booking.

03 Take the hassle out of groups

Onggijip says staff grill the meat and pre-sear it, and lists 30–52 seats, valet, and Naver/CatchTable booking.

Tip for owners

For group sets, list drinks, bottle count, price and party size. Set the mix with your sales rep based on real orders and enquiries.

Source: public Instagram posts, collected 2026.10.17. Hwangnam (Gwanghwamun), Joyanggwan (Gangnam), Onggijip (Apgujeong). Selected examples; not the whole market or results.

Sat, 10/31: Halloween

2026

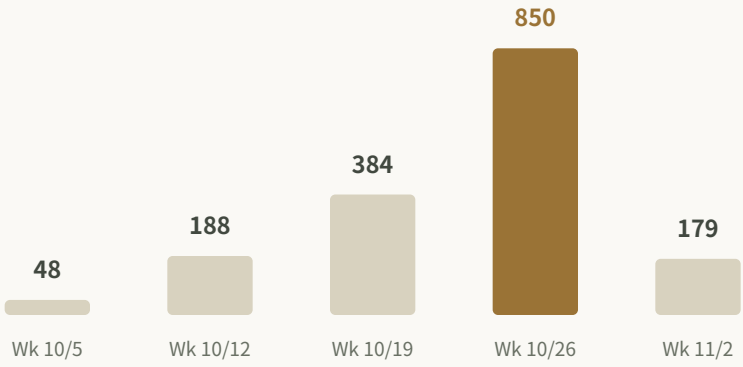
10.31

SATURDAY

Plan Fri–Sat operations early

Last year's Instagram · Halloween posts

Co-mentions with bar, pub, pocha, etc. · posts



Last year, posts peaked in the last week of October. This year it falls on a Saturday, so **check your bookings and local events** to plan Fri–Sat stock and staff. Post counts alone can't predict visits.

Ops check

If crowds are likely, also check entry flow and waiting space.

Source: Sometrend, Instagram, weekly 2025.10.5–11.2. Co-mentions of Halloween with bar, pub, pocha, izakaya, hof and cocktail. Post counts do not indicate actual visits.

3 checks this week

1 **Is group booking info clear at a glance?**

List max party size, parking, rooms and how to book on Naver Place and your Instagram bio.

2 **Are lunch group terms set?**

If you can take lunch groups, set bookable hours, menu, minimum party size and prep time.

3 **Are set drinks and quantities clear?**

List included drinks (soju, beer, etc.) and bottle counts. Discuss adding wine with your sales rep based on orders and storage.

Q4 calendar

Oct 21 (Wed)	**Sewang Trading closed**	Please place safety-stock orders by Oct 20 (Tue)
10/30~31	**Halloween Fri–Sat**	Prep stock and staff for bookings and local events
Late Nov	**Check year-end group readiness**	See when Instagram posts rose in past years
Mid-Dec	**Ready for a likely year-end peak**	Based on past posts · this year's peak not confirmed

Next issue: Oct 28 (Wed). Halloween weekend: how each district should prep menus, decor and operations.

A partner that grows with you

Year-end group sets, wine and by-the-glass picks,
and safety stock before our closure: your sales rep can help.

For orders and delivery, contact the rep for your area.

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Head of Sales

Park Jeong-eon Exec. Dir. — **010-3286-9489**
Yeoksam · Nonhyeon · Sinsa · Cheongdam · Daechi · Samseong / Seocho · Bangbae / Gwanak · Dongjak

Son Seung-il Managing Dir. — **010-7539-3535**
Franchise

Lee Won-cheol Director — **010-3354-2101**
Gangbuk · Jongno · Jung-gu / Dongdaemun · Jungnang · Nowon · Dobong / Seongdong · Gwangjin

Chae Hyeon-yong Director — **010-8889-3057**
Hotels · Wine

Kim Hwan Director — **010-4789-3282**
Incheon / Bucheon · Siheung · Ansan

Oh Geon-hoon Director — **010-3495-6515**
Songpa · Gangdong · Jamsil / Japanese liquor

Shin Hong-cheol Director — **010-9259-6474**
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Yoo Gwang-seok GM — **010-4565-6039**
Hanam · Misa · Guri · Namyangju · Uijeongbu

Seong Hyeon-woo GM — **010-3375-3646**
Yongsan · Itaewon · Hannam / Mapo · Seodaemun · Eunpyeong

Hwang Hyeon-woong Deputy GM — **010-9123-4341**
New accounts

Jung Min-seong CEO — **010-3964-9290**

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